

Amanda Jackson

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SUMMARY

Senior QA/Testing professional, 25 years in. Track record of taking ambiguous problems through design, delivery and the unglamorous operational work that follows. I mentor deliberately and write things down. Core stack: Python, Java, JavaScript.

ACADEMIC HISTORY

Bachelor, Communications

Delft University of Technology | 1997 – 2000

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Cobalt Systems — Staff QA Engineer

Jul '18 – Present | Gomezbury (Hybrid)

- Drove accessibility coverage from 4% to 94% of core journeys.
- Built the defect triage process and reporting the engineering leads still use.
- Automated 50 regression suites with CI/CD, cutting the manual test cycle by 70%.
- Reduced escaped defects by 60% through risk-based test prioritisation.
- Integrated automated checks into the CI/CD pipeline, blocking 15 faulty releases.

Clearwater Systems — Senior QA Analyst

Apr '07 – May '18 | Burnsvew (Remote)

- Introduced flaky-test quarantine, taking suite reliability from 6% to 92%.
- Owned release sign-off for 40 services, coordinating across product and support.
- Mentored 6 manual testers into automation roles.
- Cut end-to-end suite runtime from 15 hours to 12 minutes through parallelisation.

QA Engineer, Datadog

May '03 – Nov '06 | Williamstown

- Partnered with developers to shift testing left, embedding QA in refinement sessions.
- Set up cross-browser and device coverage in Playwright, catching defects staging had missed.
- Built a performance harness in Playwright simulating 8k concurrent users.

Shopify — QA Engineer

Dec '01 – May '03 | Fordton (On-site)

- Established test data management practices later adopted by 15 teams.
- Wrote the team's testing strategy, separating unit, contract and end-to-end responsibilities.
- Introduced written design docs and an RFC process, cutting rework late in delivery.

Redwood Data — QA Engineer

Feb '00 – Aug '01 | Lake Stephenport (Remote (UK))

- Standardised the team's tooling with GitHub Actions, ending long-running environment drift.
- Led a team of 6 through a full replatforming with no missed delivery dates.
- Ran retrospectives and drove the follow-up actions to completion, not just to the board.

SKILLS & TOOLS

Languages: Python, Java, JavaScript, TypeScript, Kotlin, C#

Frameworks: Hugging Face, Node.js

Cloud & DevOps: GitHub Actions, CI/CD, Jenkins

Testing & Tooling: Selenium, Postman, Jira, Playwright, pytest

OPEN SOURCE

Charity chatbot

Built a Node.js assistant for a local charity to answer volunteer questions; retired it once they moved to a supported platform.

CERTIFICATIONS

Certified ScrumMaster (CSM) — Scrum Alliance, 2022

Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) — ISC2, 2019

PUBLICATIONS

"Framing effects in crisis communication" - co-authored conference paper, 2000.

VOLUNTEER EXPERIENCE

Committee member, local QA meetup - organise speakers and venue.